```
end
puts a_long_string
```

produces:

```
Faster than a speeding bullet, more powerful than
a locomotive, able to leap tall buildings in a single
bound—look, up there in the sky, it's a bird, it's a
plane, it's Superman!
```

You can also have multiple here documents on a single line. Each acts as a separate string. The bodies of the here documents are fetched sequentially from the source lines that follow:

```
print <<-STRING1, <<-STRING2
  Concat
        STRING1
  enate
  STRING2
```

produces:

```
Concat
enate
```

This is generally considered super confusing.

Note that Ruby does not strip leading spaces off the contents of the strings in these cases. If you want to do so, you can call a method on the initial delimiter, `x = <<EOL.strip`

Strings and Encodings

An *encoding* is a mechanism for translating bits into characters. For many years, most developers who used English used ASCII, a 7-bit encoding of English characters, such as binary 101 to capital A—it used to be extremely common for programming books to include a table of ASCII values as an appendix. Somewhat later, an 8-bit representation called Latin-1 that included most characters in European language became common.

All of these were eventually superseded by Unicode,[1] a global standard for all text characters used in all languages. A Unicode character is two bytes long, however, which makes a Unicode string twice as long internally as a Latin-1 string. As a result, the overwhelming majority of web pages use an encoding called UTF-8, which represents any unicode character, but uses fewer bytes for ASCII or Latin-1 characters. UTF-8 is not the only encoding you'll encounter, but is the default for Ruby and the one you will likely encounter most often.

Every string in Ruby has an associated encoding. The default encoding of a string literal depends on the encoding of the source file that contains it. With no explicit encoding specified, a source file (and its strings) is encoded using UTF-8:

```
plain_string = "dog"
puts "Encoding of #{plain_string.inspect} is #{plain_string.encoding}"
```

produces:

```
Encoding of "dog" is UTF-8
```

1. https://home.unicode.org